

Why was the study undertaken?

Folliculitis decalvans (FD) is the most common form of primary neutrophilic scarring alopecia, yet it remains a challenging condition to diagnose and manage due to its chronic, relapsing course and potential for significant hair loss. Despite its clinical importance, there is a lack of standardized diagnostic criteria and evidence-based treatment guidelines. The disease often requires long-term therapy, and treatment strategies are frequently based on case reports, small series, and expert opinion rather than robust clinical trials.

Given the complexity of FD and the wide range of therapeutic options with variable efficacy, there is a clear need for consensus recommendations to guide clinicians in everyday practice. The European Academy for Dermatology and Venereology (EADV) Task Force on Hair Diseases therefore undertook this initiative to develop a position statement that synthesizes current evidence and expert experience. The goal was to establish practical, clinically relevant recommendations for the diagnosis and management of FD, with an emphasis on controlling inflammation, preventing disease progression, and improving patient outcomes.